



HUATULCO RACE HISTORY

Elite Analysis · Past 8 Years · May 2026

USA Triathlon High Performance

Race Week Schedule

Huatulco



June 12 – 14, 2026 • Plaza Santa Cruz Huatulco, Mexico

Friday • June 12 <i>Familiarization Day</i>	
10:00	Bike familiarization — 3 laps from Bahía Santa Cruz
10:30	Run familiarization
11:00 – 11:45	Swim familiarization — Santa Cruz

Saturday • June 13 <i>Briefing & Packet Pickup</i>	
16:00 – 16:30	★ Mandatory Elite athlete meeting — Hotel Biniguenda

16:30 – 17:00	Packet pickup — Hotel Biniguenda
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Sunday • June 14 <i>RACE DAY</i>	
05:30	Elite Female lounge opens
06:30	★ ELITE FEMALE START
07:45	Elite Male lounge opens
08:30	★ ELITE MALE START
10:00	Awards ceremony

Key Course Differentiators

Huatulco



HUATULCO

Set around Bahía Santa Cruz on Mexico’s Pacific coast, Huatulco is a hot, humid sprint-distance World Cup. The swim is usually non-wetsuit in very warm water; the bike includes a short climb and corresponding descent. The run is also exposed enough that heat management becomes a major performance limiter. This race often stays close deep into the run, but hilly run, and heat has led to a high DNF/LAP/DNS history. Heat prep leading into and on race day are critical for performance.

COURSE FEATURES

Heat and humidity are the defining environmental factors. Women start earlier at 06:30, but historical race conditions still show warm air, very warm water, and frequent high humidity.

The swim is a single 750 m loop from Santa Cruz with warm water that has historically sat around 29–32°C when recorded, **making wetsuits extremely unlikely.**

The bike is four laps of a 5 km circuit and has a brief climb. **The only true breakaway occurred in 2025.**

The run is two laps and includes enough elevation to slow 5 km times significantly **The fastest time in several years was 14:45**

COURSE AT A GLANCE

Swim:	750 m
Bike:	20.0 km
Run:	5.0 km
Format:	Sprint Triathlon
Bike Laps:	4
Run Laps:	2

QUICK LINKS

- Current Race Info:
[Race Info](#) | [2026 World Triathlon Cup Huatulco](#)
- Last Year's Results:
[Results](#) | [2025 World Triathlon Cup Huatulco](#)

Swim Course Profile

Huatulco



Source: asdeporte 2026 Elite Swim course map (Natación Elite — Bahía de Santa Cruz)

750 m • single lap

Ocean — Bahía de Santa Cruz (protected marina)

Distance	Layout	Start
750 m	U-shape rectangle	Beach start
Water Temp	Wetsuit	Lap Count
30.5 °C (7-yr avg)	Likely non-wetsuit	1

Tactical Notes

- Single 750 m loop: 300 m east leg, 150 m across south, 300 m west leg, beach exit by transition
- Tight rectangle inside the protected marina. Typically, has minimal chop, current normally low at 06:30 start
- Two turn buoys at the south end with kayak in position here
- Sun rising due east at 06:30. Potential to swim into glare at the start

Bike Course Profile

Huatulco



20 km • 4 × 5 km loops

Closed urban circuit (Bahía de Santa Cruz → Vialidad 5 → return)

Elevation / Lap

+84.4 m / 84.6 m

Total Climb

~338 m

Avg Grade

3.2%

Max Climb Grade

+16.4%

Max Descent

-14.9%

Loops

4 × 5 km

Tactical Implications

- Out-and-back along Blvd Santa Cruz with a tight technical hairpin at the neutral wheel station
- Single sustained climb up Vialidad 5 is short but punchy (max 16.4%)
- Quick descent back into town center; max -14.9% grade
- Tight start/finish chicane through transition

Run Course Profile

Huatulco



5.0 km • 2 × 2.5 km

Paved urban — Blvd Santa Cruz / Camino a Santa Cruz

Distance
5.0 km

Lap Structure
2 × 2.5 km

Total Climb
~111 m

Avg Grade
4.2%

Max ▲ / ▼
+17.3% / -15.3%

Heat Risk
HIGH

Tactical Notes

- Hilly 2.5 km out-and-back loop. +55.3 m gain per lap
- Max climb 17.3% on Camino a Santa Cruz; Short steep climb
- Steep -15.3% descent back into Bahía de Santa Cruz
- 08:30 men's start will likely have hot temperatures
- Three turns into the closing 0.5km of the race. Come into sprint with good positioning

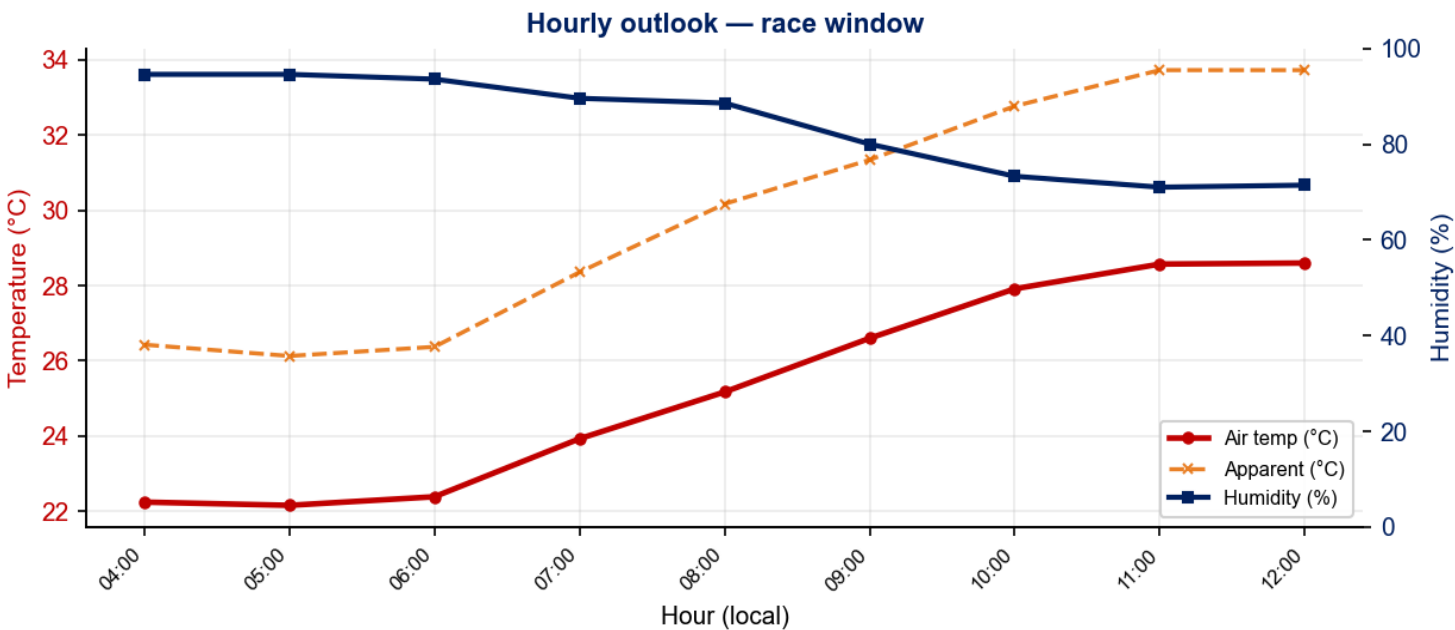
Source: asdeporte 2026 Elite Run course map (Carrera Elite — Boulevard Santa Cruz)

Race-Day Weather Outlook

Huatulco



2026-06-14 • Historical climatology



Female start — 06:30		
Temperature	Apparent / Heat	Humidity
23.8 °C	28.3 °C	91%
Wind	UV peak	Heat Stress
3.7 km/h	—	HIGH

Male start — 08:30		
Temperature	Apparent / Heat	Humidity
26.6 °C	31.4 °C	81%
Wind	UV peak	Heat Stress
3.8 km/h	—	HIGH

Hydration & Cooling Cues

- Men's race runs 2.8 °C hotter than women's

Data source: Open-Meteo. Forecast will replace climatology once race day is within 16 days.

Environmental Risk Profile

Huatulco



RACE-DAY WEATHER (08:00–11:00 local)

Year	Date	Air Temp	Humidity	Wind km/h	Precip mm
2018	Jun 10	29.2	72%	10	0.0
2019	Jun 08	28.3	77%	4	0.1
2021	Jun 12	26.8	82%	16	0.0
2022	Jun 18	28	68%	6	0.0
2023	Jun 17	32.8	60%	7	0.1
2024	May 18	29.3	62%	7	0.0
2025	Jun 22	24	96%	4	2.6

AIR QUALITY (Open-Meteo archive)

Year	PM2.5	EU AQI	UV Index	Risk
2018	—	—	—	—
2019	—	—	—	—
2021	—	—	—	—
2022	—	—	—	—
2023	7.7	21	5.3	Fair
2024	4.3	20	4.3	Good
2025	3.4	16	4.5	Good

HEALTH & WATER QUALITY RISK FACTORS

Water Quality: No public Huatulco race-week illness cluster found.

Athlete Health Incidents: No known Huatulco-specific GI illness pattern found.

Water Temperature: Historically very warm when recorded: 2022 men/women ~29–31°C, 2023 ~31.7–31.8°C, 2024 ~30°C, 2025 ~29°C. Expect non-wetsuit and warm-water swim.

Heat / Humidity: High risk. Historical race-window air temperatures range from ~24°C to 35°C, with humidity often above 70% and as high as 96% in 2025. The women start at 06:30, which may offer slightly cooler temperatures.

Weather and AQ data: Open-Meteo historical archive (archive-api.open-meteo.com). EU AQI: Good ≤20, Fair ≤40, Moderate ≤60, Poor ≤80, Very Poor >80.

Who to Watch



ELITE MEN

Top 3 Ranked on Startlist

Rank	Athlete	Points
15	Tyler Mislawchuk	2,943
42	Aoba Yasumatsu	2,080
52	Liam Donnelly	1,939

Returning Podium Athletes on Startlist

- 2. Alejandro Rodriguez Diez: 2nd Place in 2025 (00:55:07)
- 3. Kuba Gajda: 3rd Place in 2025 (00:55:11)

ELITE WOMEN

Top 3 Ranked on Startlist

Rank	Athlete	Points
24	Maria Carolina Velasquez Soto	2,558
25	Rosa Maria Tapia Vidal	2,515
49	Danielle Orie	1,941

Returning Podium Athletes on Startlist

- 1. Maria Carolina Velasquez Soto: 1st Place in 2025 (01:00:08)
- 3. Elizabeth Bravo: 3rd Place in 2025 (01:00:09)

Rankings = current World Triathlon rankings snapshot;

ELITE MEN



Race Overview — Elite Men

Huatulco



3 KEYS TO SUCCESS

1

Prepare for a non-wetsuit swim. Water temperature around 30C will not only be non-wetsuit but feel very warm. With such warm temps, this has limited the top swimmers from attacking the swim. Expect for at least 15 athletes to exit the water close to each other with the main group not far behind.

2

2025 saw the first true breakaway stick at this course. However, the lead group of 3 was only able to get ~40s for the effort. Likewise in 2023 a much larger breakaway group only put ~60s on the chase. With two long straightaways, expect for the bike to come together if there is a train coming from behind.

3

Heat and elevation on the run drives a slow 5K. The fastest time since 2018 is 14:45 and many years have had no one go under 15:00. Trust in the Park City hill training and make your move against the competition on the second lap here. To achieve a top 10 result, you'll likely need to be within 35-45 seconds of the winner.

Results Summary — Elite Men

Huatulco



Year	Date	Category	Field	DNF/LAP/ DNS	Winner	Winner Time	Air Temp	Water Temp	Swim km	Bike km	Run km
2018	Jun 10	World Cup	66	6	Lopez	55:32	29.2	—	—	—	—
2019	Jun 08	World Cup	62	7	Mislawchuk	55:04	28.3	—	—	—	—
2021	Jun 12	World Cup	60	11	Mislawchuk	53:09	26.8	—	—	—	—
2022	Jun 18	World Cup *	65	8	Grau	53:47	28	29	0.75	20.0	5.0
2023	Jun 17	World Cup	64	6	Fajardo	54:13	32.8	31.7	0.75	20.0	5.0
2024	May 18	World Cup *	52	7	Murray	58:07	29.3	30	0.75	22.2	5.0
2025	Jun 22	World Cup *	49	4	Sagiv	54:53	24	29	0.75	20.0	5.0

2024 had longer course and
~3-4 minute longer time

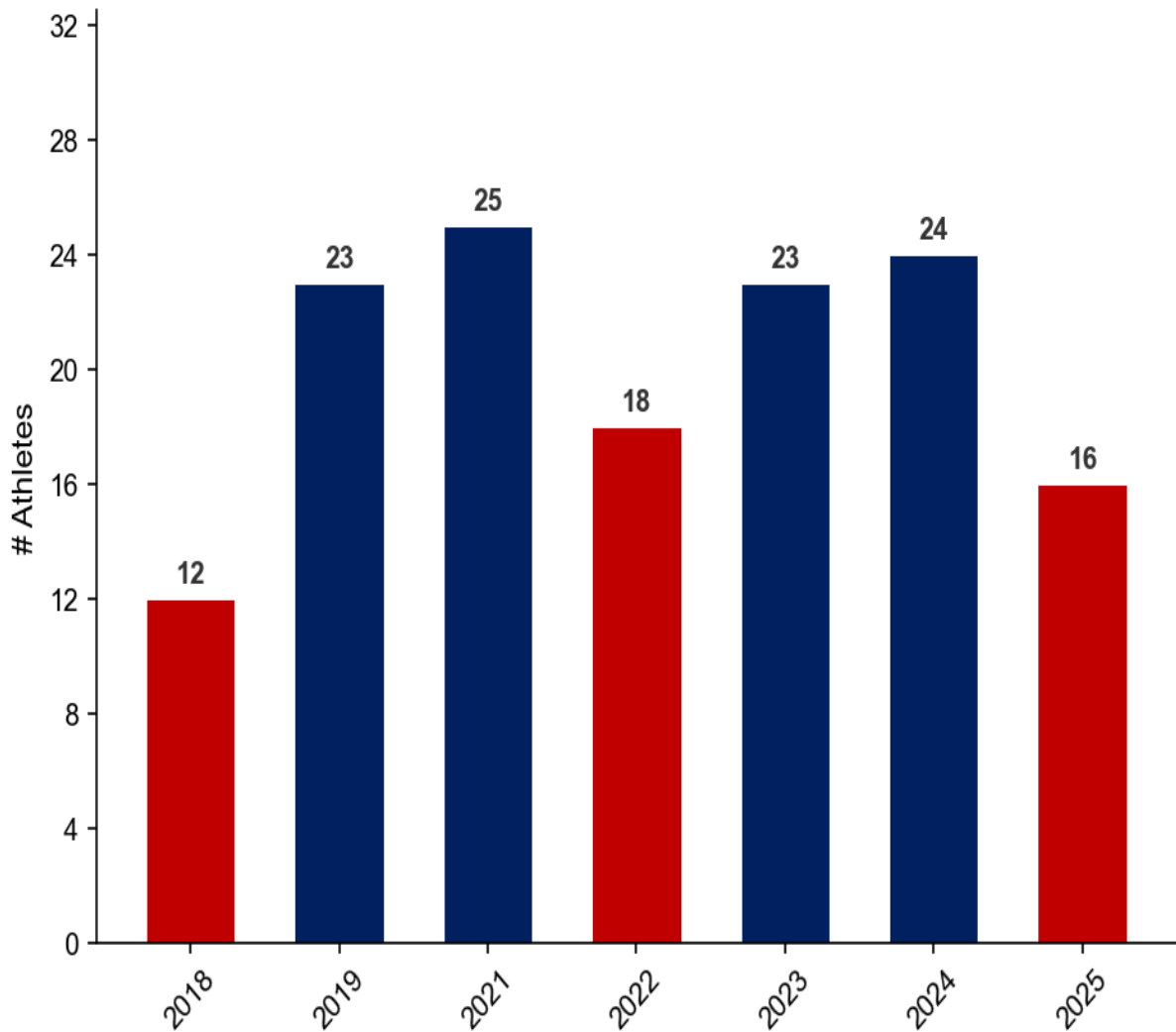
* Course distance changed vs. prior year

Swim Exit Dynamics — Elite Men

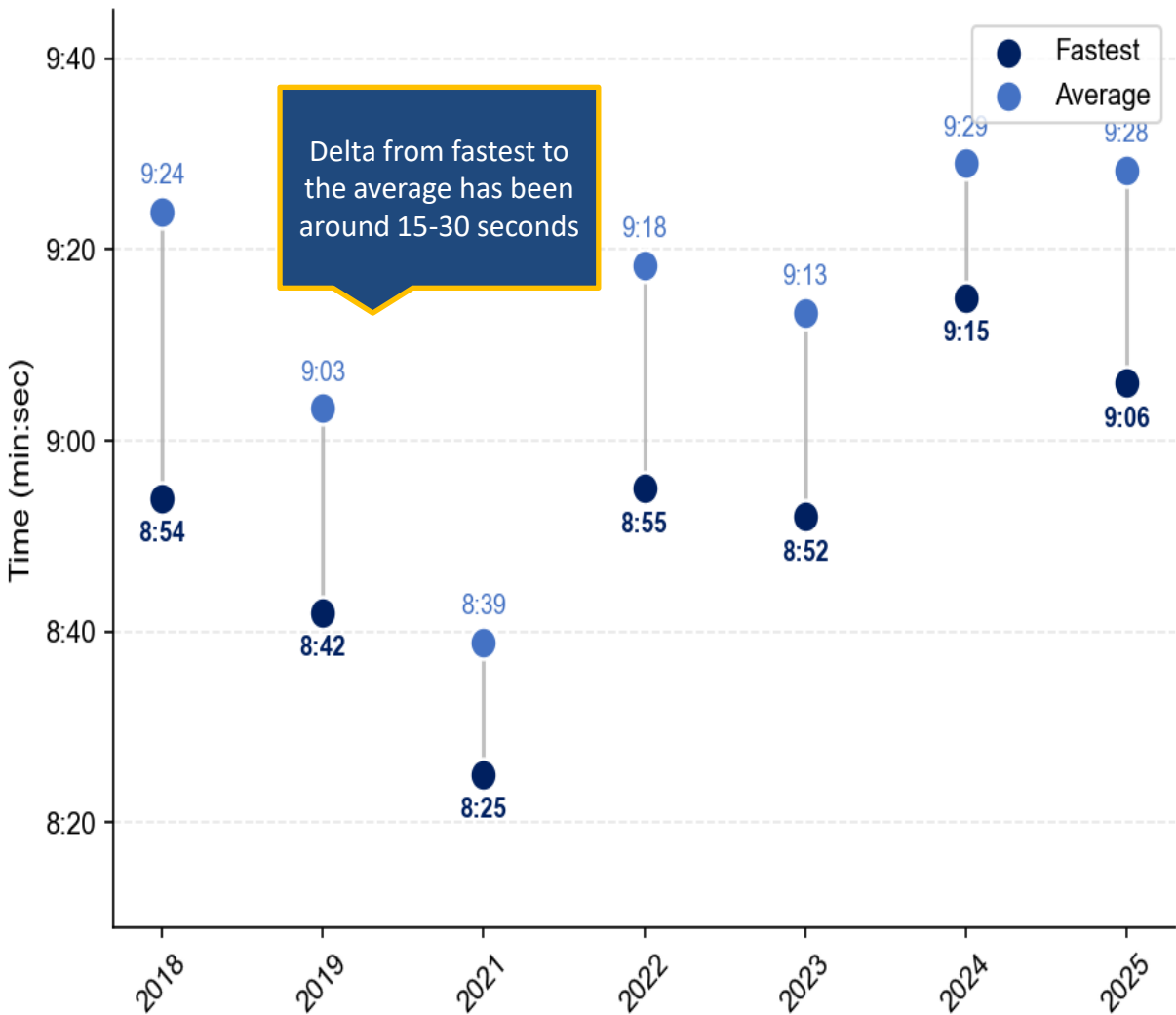
Huatulco



Athletes Within 15 sec of Swim Leader



Fastest vs. Average Swim Time



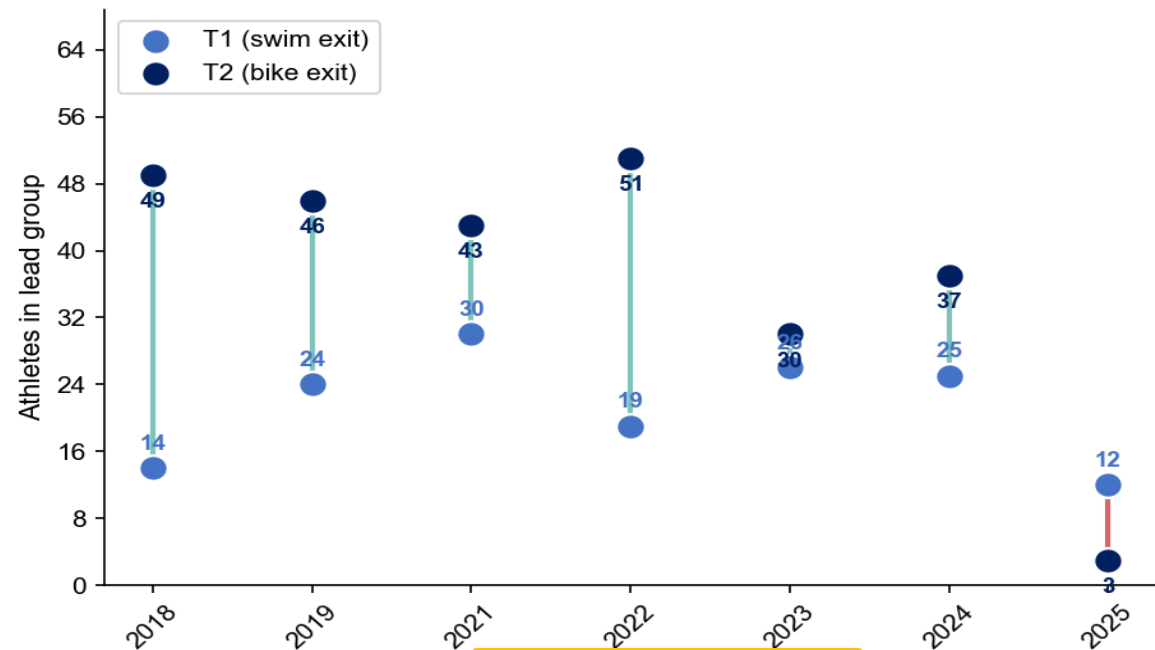
Bike Pack Evolution — Elite Men

Huatulco

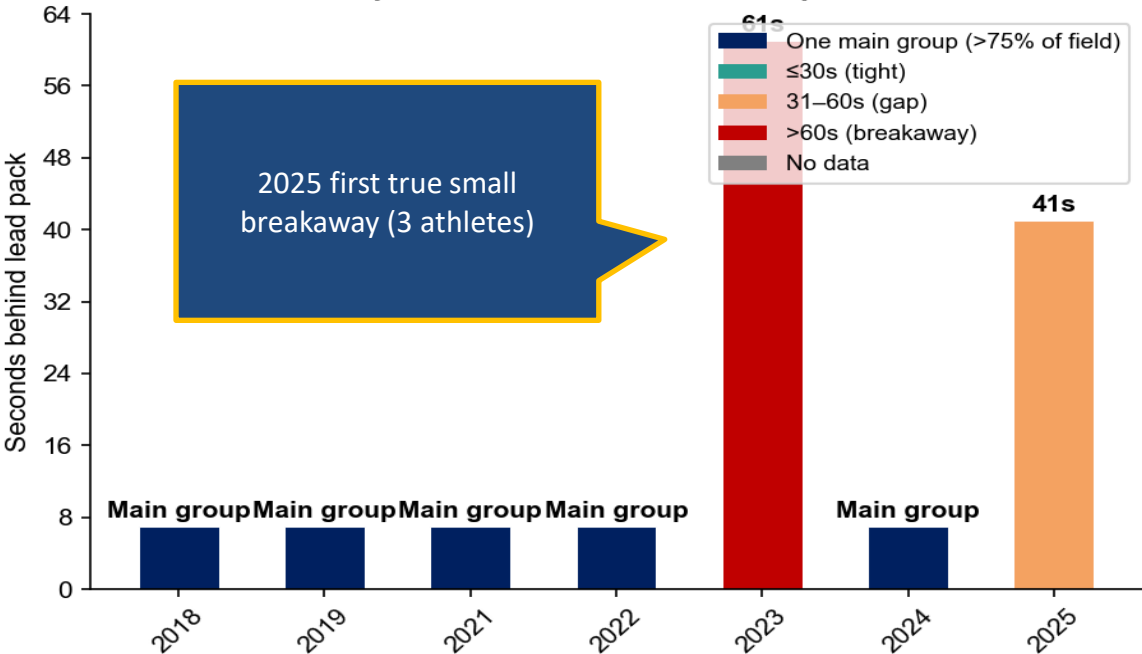


Lead pack = athletes within 15 sec of leader. T1 = lead group entering the bike; T2 = lead group exiting the bike.

Lead Pack Size: Entering T1 vs Exiting T2



Gap: Lead Pack → Chase Group at T2



Year	Lead Size @ T1	Lead Size @ T2	Change	Chase Group @ T2	Chase Gap*
2018	14	49	+35	1	42s
2019	24	46	+22	7	88s
2021	30	43	+13	1	187s
2022	19	51	+32	1	103s
2023	26	30	+4	22	61s
2024	25	37	+12	1	237s
2025	12	3	-9	31	41s

Lead pack = athletes within 15 sec of leader. Chase group = athletes within 15 sec of the first athlete outside the lead pack. * Chase Gap = seconds from the last lead-pack athlete to the first chase-group athlete at T2.

Run Split Analysis — Elite Men

Huatulco

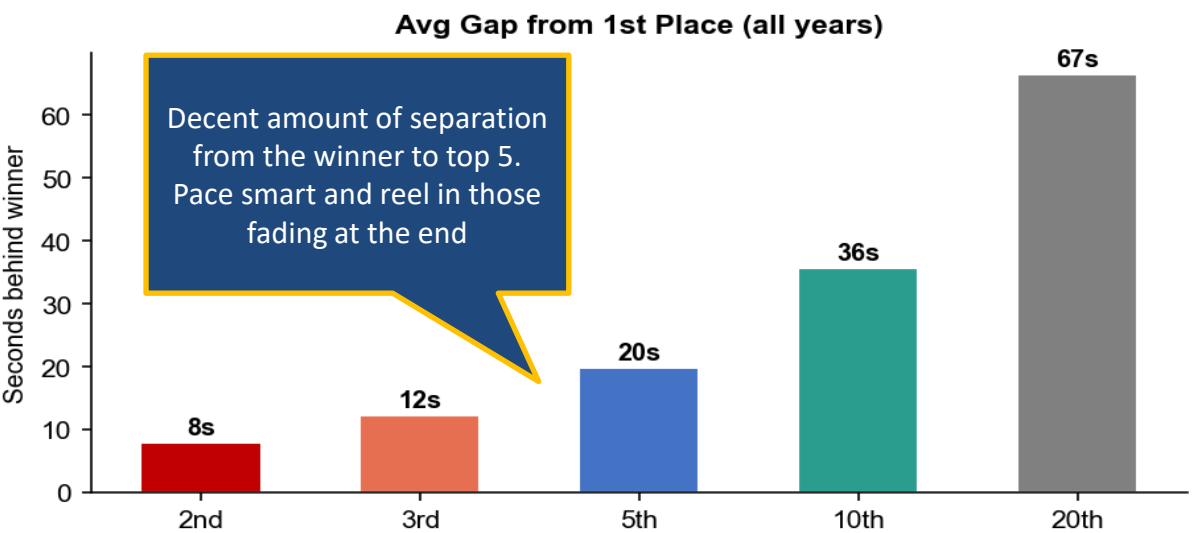
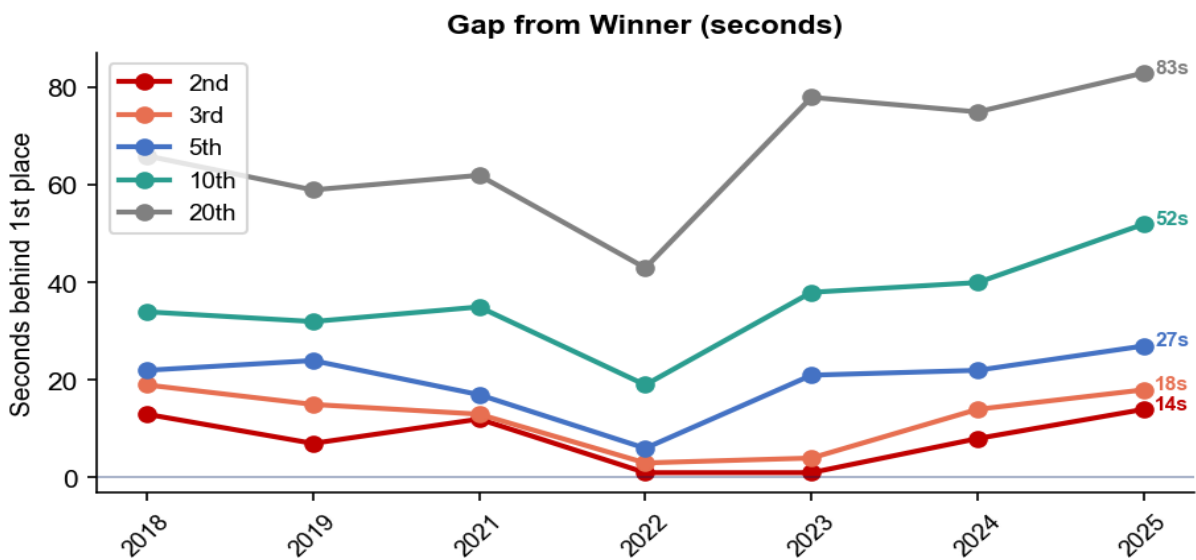


Fastest vs. Average Run Split by Year



Key Position Times — Elite Men

Huatulco



Year	1st	2nd	3rd	5th	10th	20th
2018	55:32	55:45 +13s	55:51 +19s	55:54 +22s	56:06 +34s	56:38 +66s
2019	55:04	55:11 +7s	55:19 +15s	55:28 +24s	55:36 +32s	56:03 +59s
2021	53:09	53:21 +12s	53:22 +13s	53:26 +17s	53:44 +35s	54:11 +62s
2022	53:47	53:48 +1s	53:50 +3s	53:53 +6s	54:06 +19s	54:30 +43s
2023	54:13	54:14 +1s	54:17 +4s	54:34 +21s	54:51 +38s	55:31 +78s
2024	58:07	58:15 +8s	58:21 +14s	58:29 +22s	58:47 +40s	59:22 +75s
2025	54:53	55:07 +14s	55:11 +18s	55:20 +27s	55:45 +52s	56:16 +83s

Race Conditions — Elite Men

Huatulco



Year	Date	Air Temp	Humidity	Wind (km/h)	Precip (mm)	Water Temp	Wetsuit	Conditions
2018	Jun 10	29.2	72%	10	0.0	—	—	—
2019	Jun 08	28.3	77%	4	0.1	—	—	—
2021	Jun 12	26.8	82%	16	0.0	—	—	—
2022	Jun 18	28	68%	6	0.0	29	forbidden	—
2023	Jun 17	32.8	60%	7	0.1	31.7	—	—
2024	May 18	29.3	62%	7	0.0	30	forbidden	—
2025	Jun 22	24	96%	4	2.6	29	forbidden	—

Air temp, humidity, wind, and precipitation sourced from Open-Meteo historical archive (race window 08:00–11:00 local) where WT API data is absent. Values marked * are Open-Meteo estimates. Water temp and wetsuit ruling are from the World Triathlon API per program.

ELITE WOMEN



Race Overview — Elite Women

Huatulco



3 KEYS TO SUCCESS

1

Stay attached through the swim and first bike lap. Huatulco does not always reward an all-out swim break, but missing the first organized group can be costly from an energy standpoint. The women's race has ranged from very small groups at T1 to larger groups by T2, so put yourself close enough to the leaders that you can attach yourself on the bike.

2

While athletes have historically been able to bike to the front group a small to medium breakaway is common in the women's racing here. If you are able to make a breakaway of ~20 athletes it's not uncommon to put ~2 minutes into the chasers, helping solidify better positioning into the run.

3

The Huatulco 5K is slower than a flat sprint-course run because of heat and elevation. Managing your effort on the short but steep climb amid increasing heat in the morning is key to putting yourself in a strong position over the final 0.5 km. Based on recent gaps, a top-10 result likely requires staying within roughly one minute of the winner, and podium contention has been seen photo finishes in back to back years.

Results Summary — Elite Women

Huatulco



Year	Date	Category	Field	DNF/LAP/ DNS	Winner	Winner Time	Air Temp	Water Temp	Swim km	Bike km	Run km
2018	Jun 10	World Cup	41	3	Sodaro	1:01:14	29.2	—	—	—	—
2019	Jun 08	World Cup	42	4	Rappaport	1:00:56	28.3	—	—	—	—
2021	Jun 12	World Cup	43	5	Pedersen	1:00:24	26.8	—	—	—	—
2022	Jun 18	World Cup *	56	4	Koch	1:00:01	29	31	0.75	20.0	5.0
2023	Jun 17	World Cup	61	7	Corral	1:00:31	35	31.8	0.75	20.0	5.0
2024	May 18	World Cup *	45	10	Pedersen	1:04:54	33.9	30	0.75	22.2	5.0
2025	Jun 22	World Cup *	35	3	Soto	1:00:08	24	29	0.75	20.0	5.0

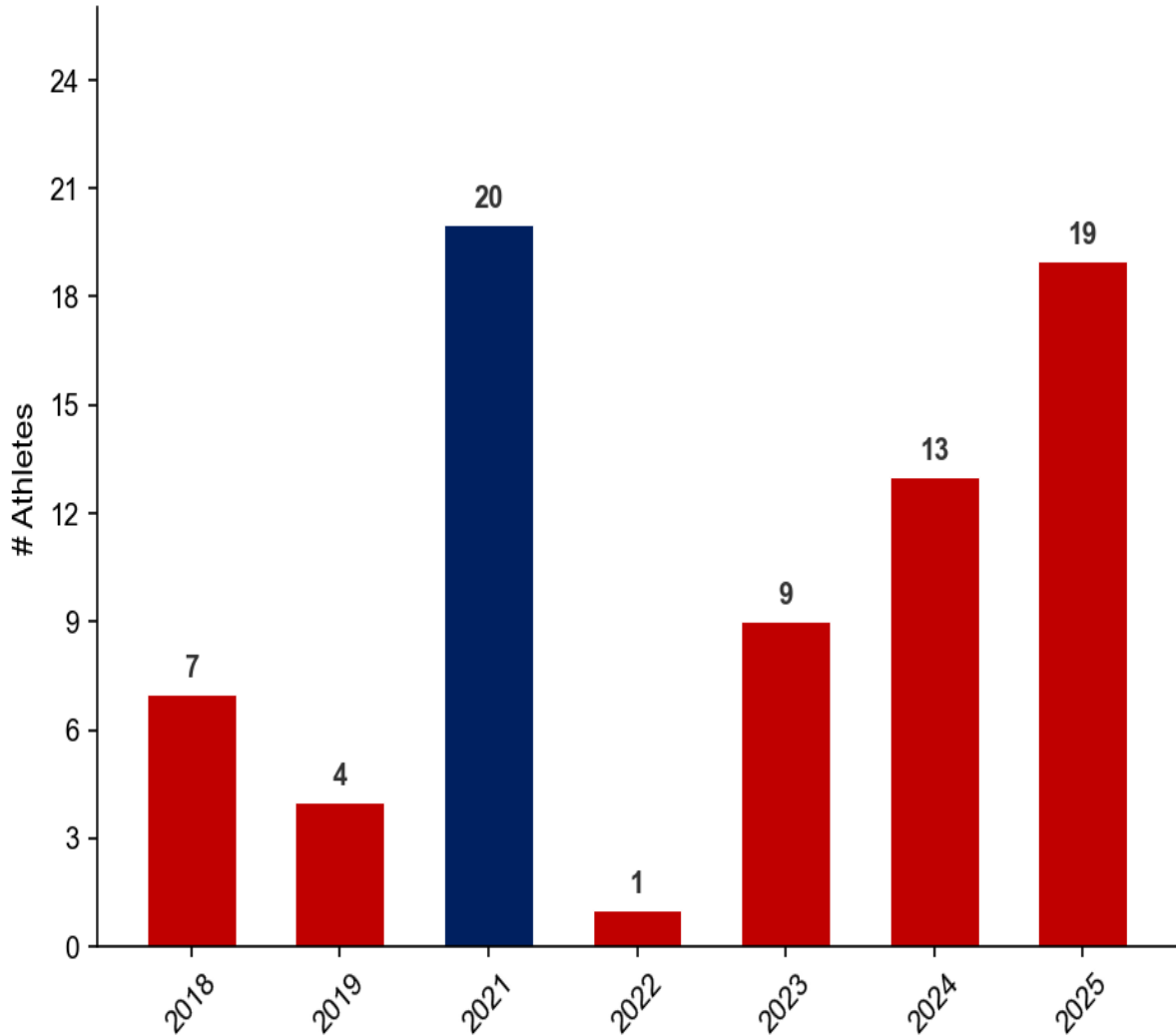
* Course distance changed vs. prior year

Swim Exit Dynamics — Elite Women

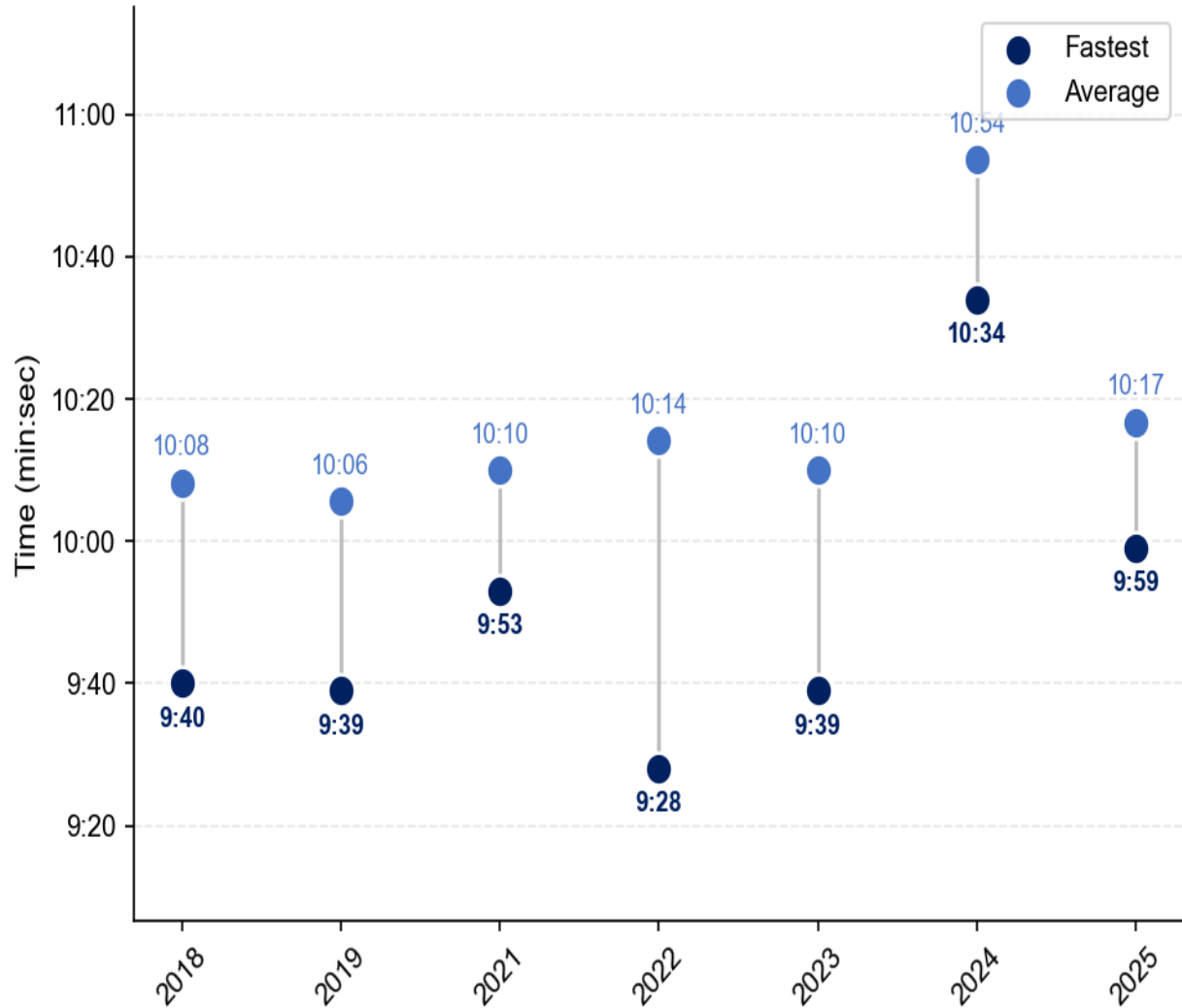
Huatulco



Athletes Within 15 sec of Swim Leader



Fastest vs. Average Swim Time

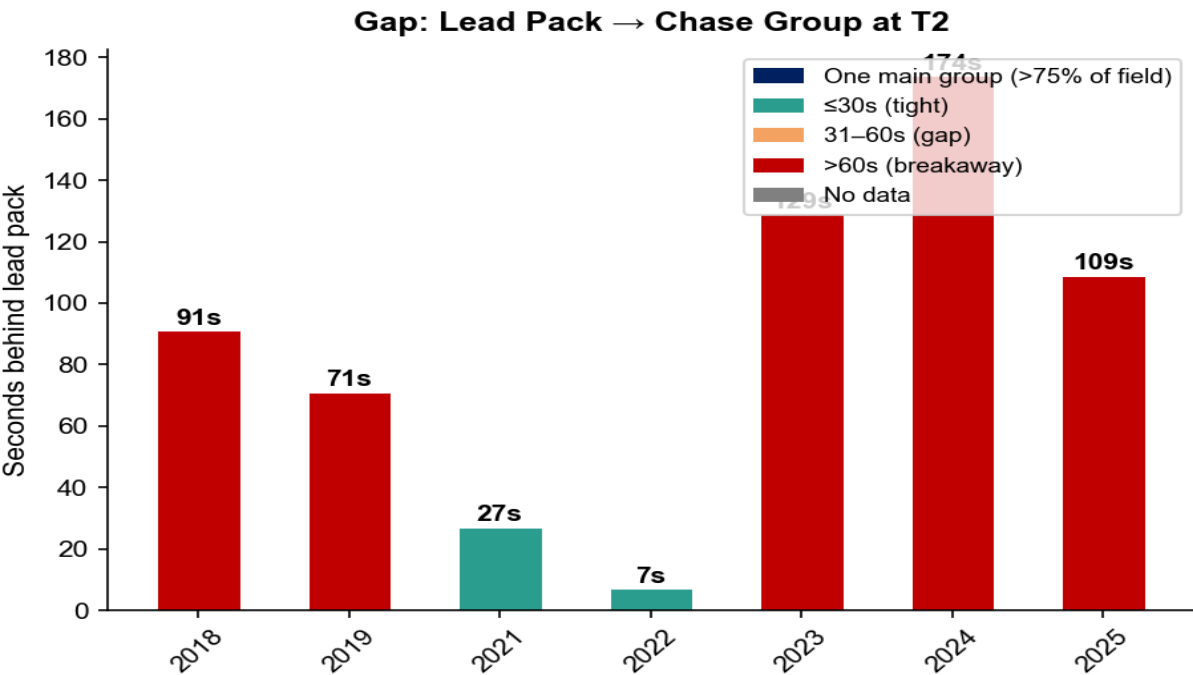
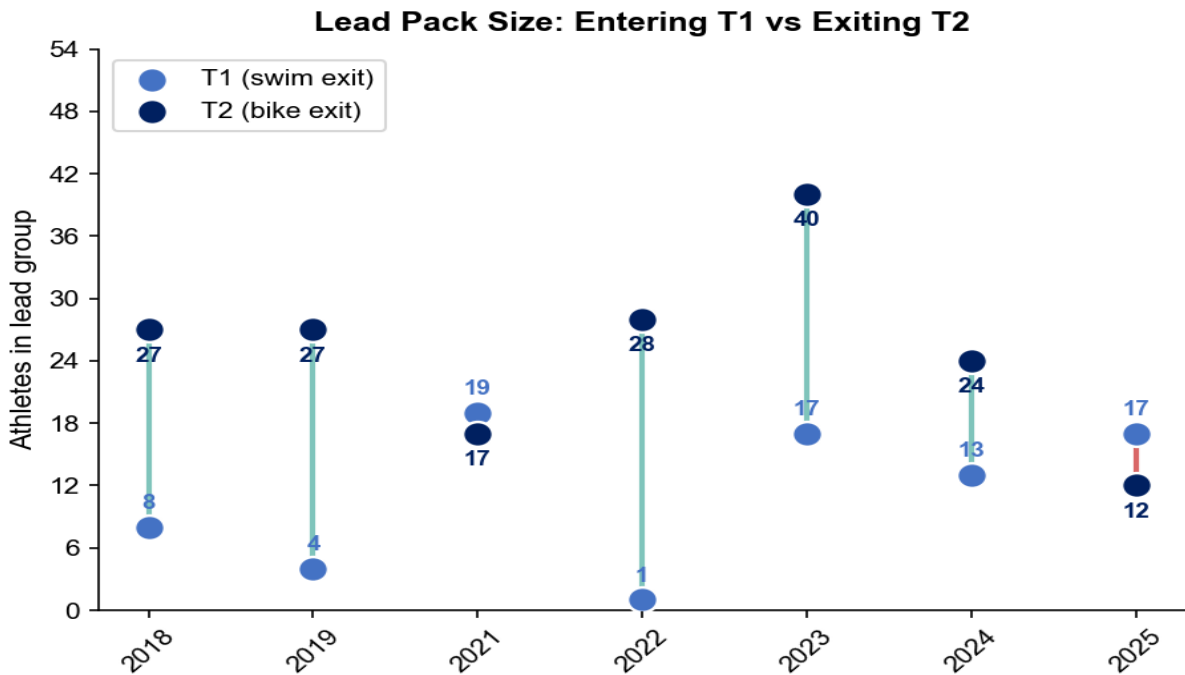


Bike Pack Evolution — Elite Women

Huatulco



Lead pack = athletes within 15 sec of leader. T1 = lead group entering the bike; T2 = lead group exiting the bike.



Year	Lead Size @ T1	Lead Size @ T2	Change	Chase Group @ T2	Chase Gap*
2018	8	27	+19	5	91s
2019	4	27	+23	7	71s
2021	19	17	-2	1	27s
2022	1	28	+27	1	7s
2023	17	40	+23	1	129s
2024	13	24	+11	5	174s
2025	17	12	-5	14	109s

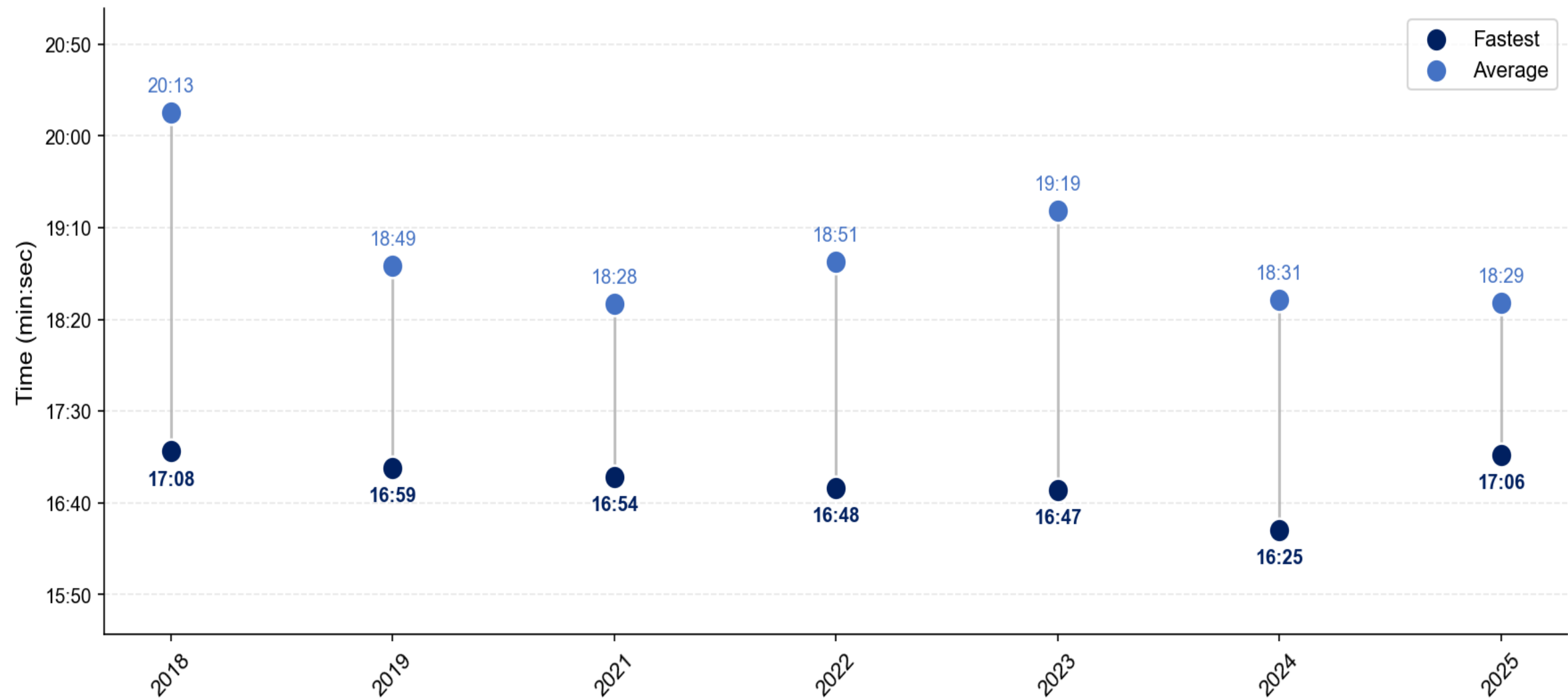
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Run Split Analysis — Elite Women

Huatulco



Fastest vs. Average Run Split by Year

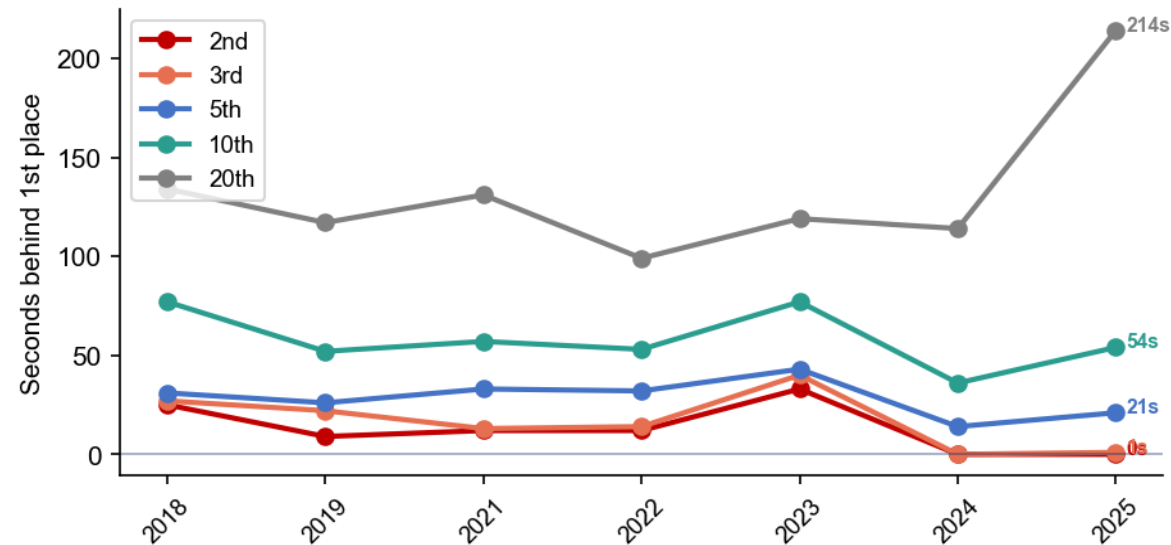


Key Position Times — Elite Women

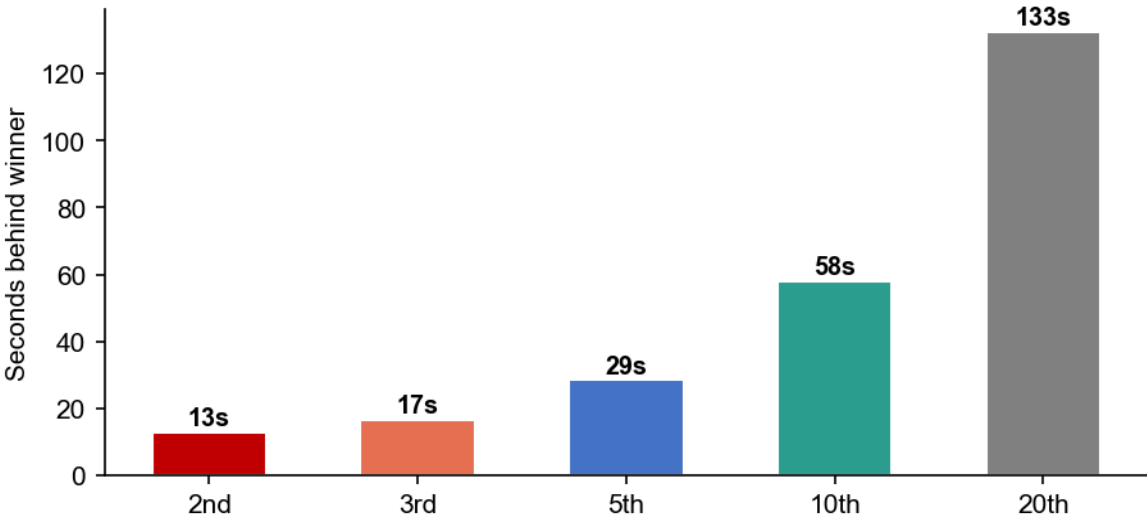
Huatulco



Gap from Winner (seconds)



Avg Gap from 1st Place (all years)



Year	1st	2nd	3rd	5th	10th	20th
2018	1:01:14	1:01:39 +25s	1:01:41 +27s	1:01:45 +31s	1:02:31 +77s	1:03:28 +134s
2019	1:00:56	1:01:05 +9s	1:01:18 +22s	1:01:22 +26s	1:01:48 +52s	1:02:53 +117s
2021	1:00:24	1:00:36 +12s	1:00:37 +13s	1:00:57 +33s	1:01:21 +57s	1:02:35 +131s
2022	1:00:01	1:00:13 +12s	1:00:15 +14s	1:00:33 +32s	1:00:54 +53s	1:01:40 +99s
2023	1:00:31	1:01:04 +33s	1:01:11 +40s	1:01:14 +43s	1:01:48 +77s	1:02:30 +119s
2024	1:04:54	1:04:54	1:04:54	1:05:08 +14s	1:05:30 +36s	1:06:48 +114s
2025	1:00:08	1:00:08	1:00:09 +1s	1:00:29 +21s	1:01:02 +54s	1:03:42 +214s

Race Conditions — Elite Women

Huatulco



Year	Date	Air Temp	Humidity	Wind (km/h)	Precip (mm)	Water Temp	Wetsuit	Conditions
2018	Jun 10	29.2	72%	10	0.0	—	—	—
2019	Jun 08	28.3	77%	4	0.1	—	—	—
2021	Jun 12	26.8	82%	16	0.0	—	—	—
2022	Jun 18	29	68%	6	0.0	31	forbidden	—
2023	Jun 17	35	60%	7	0.1	31.8	forbidden	—
2024	May 18	33.9	62%	7	0.0	30	forbidden	—
2025	Jun 22	24	96%	4	2.6	29	forbidden	—

Air temp, humidity, wind, and precipitation sourced from Open-Meteo historical archive (race window 08:00–11:00 local) where WT API data is absent. Values marked * are Open-Meteo estimates. Water temp and wetsuit ruling are from the World Triathlon API per program.